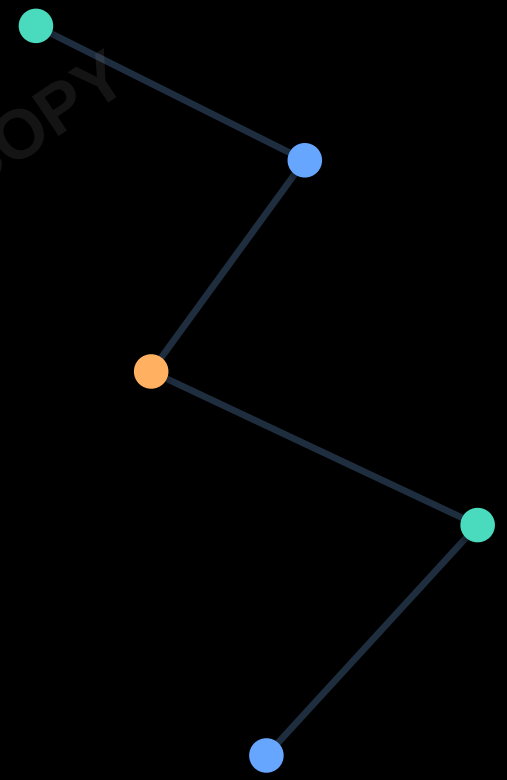
PRODUCT STRATEGY CASE STUDY | TRAVEL COMMERCE

From travel inspiration

to trips people can actually book



A concept-led case study in customer journey design, competitive positioning and product growth.

INDEPENDENT CONCEPT STUDY • NOT A LIVE LAUNCH

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Turning travel inspiration into a bookable journey.

A product strategy concept exploring how an established travel platform could reduce friction between discovery, planning and purchase.

The challenge

Travel inspiration is distributed across creators, reviews, saved posts and destination guides. Translating it into a complete, bookable trip can require multiple disconnected steps.

The opportunity

Explore a single journey that connects inspiration, itinerary composition and booking within an existing travel platform.

The approach

Map the customer journey, scan direct and adjacent competitors, define a differentiated concept, then outline a measurable proof of concept.

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Scope: strategic concept and validation plan. This is not a shipped product or a claim of measured impact.

The friction sits between “that looks amazing” and “trip booked.”

Journey hypothesis to validate through interviews, usability testing and platform data.

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01

Discover

A creator, friend or review sparks a travel idea.

→

02

Assemble

Places, stays, transport and activities live in different places.

→

03

Personalise

Adapt the plan to dates, budget and group needs.

→

04

Book

Translate the plan into available products and transactions.

→

05

Manage

Coordinate changes, confirmations and logistics.

Design opportunity: reduce the effort required to turn a high-intent idea into a coherent, bookable plan.

Build on the travel engine. Focus innovation on the customer journey.

The concept is designed for a scaled travel marketplace with existing distribution, supply and fulfilment capabilities.

Distribution

Use existing app and web journeys, customer relationships and brand reach.

Supply and fulfilment

Connect plans to live inventory, booking, payments and service operations where available.

Data and experimentation

Test adoption and incremental conversion against a baseline, with operational guardrails.

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Strategic thesis: improve the path to booking without rebuilding the travel stack.

A flexible itinerary that moves from inspiration to action.

Proposed experience direction. The final feature set would depend on research, technical feasibility and host-platform overlap.

ONE CONNECTED TRAVEL JOURNEY

Discover

Creator stories, trip templates and trusted recommendations.

Compose

Build a day-by-day plan with routes, timings, budget and alternatives.

Book

Connect itinerary elements to live availability and existing booking flows.

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

- Useful before monetisation
- Personalised, not prescriptive
- Availability-aware
- Easy to share and revise
- Integrated with existing booking

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Concept direction only. No claim is made that any target platform lacks similar capabilities.

The market is active across inspiration, planning and booking.

A directional scan of direct and adjacent players helps define the problem space. It is not a full feature audit.

Creator-led travel

GetSetYo, Fleeps and Weno

Creator or advisor profiles, travel advice, shareable itineraries and booking pathways.

Itinerary and booking

Pickyourtrail and major OTAs

Custom trip plans, package assembly, pricing and booking support.

Discovery and guidance

Tripadvisor, Viaje and concierge-led services such as Scenset

Reviews, destination guidance, AI-assisted planning or human support.

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Positioning hypothesis: a native, editable itinerary connected to host-platform inventory, evaluated on customer utility and incremental conversion.

Define success through customer and commercial outcomes.

Metrics are proposed for a future pilot. No performance results are claimed in this concept study.

Acquisition and activation

Do itineraries attract new users or activate customers who have not yet booked?

Conversion and basket

Does the journey improve search-to-book conversion, attach rate or booking value?

Retention and trust

Do users return to plan again, complete trips with fewer issues and recommend the experience?

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Primary outcome: incremental contribution after discounts, supplier costs, support, cancellations and cannibalisation.

A 90-day path from hypothesis to a scale-or-stop decision.

Illustrative plan. Timing depends on engineering capacity, integration complexity and internal approvals.

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WEEKS 1-2

Discover

Interview customers; map journeys; audit competitor experiences and technical feasibility.

WEEKS 3-4

Prototype

Build a clickable prototype; define scope, events, cohort and guardrails.

WEEKS 5-9

Pilot

Run a narrow MVP or assisted test and measure usage and booking outcomes.

WEEKS 10-12

Evaluate

Assess incrementality, customer feedback, operational impact and next investment.

Decision gate: ship a testable proof of concept, then use evidence to iterate, scale or stop.

Treat the opportunity like an internal venture.

An Entrepreneur-in-Residence model could combine entrepreneurial ownership with the resources and governance of an established platform.

Opportunity owner

Problem validation and product thesis
Feature vision and prioritisation
Customer and creator discovery
Cross-functional delivery
Pilot readout and recommendation

Host-platform support

Executive sponsor
Lean engineering and design pod
Access to relevant data and teams
Pilot audience and internal partners
Technical, legal and commercial guardrails

Agree before build

Decision rights and boundaries
POC deliverable and review date
Baseline and success metrics
IP and confidentiality terms
Milestone-linked incentives, where applicable

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Autonomy in execution. Collaboration on architecture. Accountability for evidence and outcomes.

A concept is only useful if it can be validated and delivered.

My approach combines brand, growth, partnerships and cross-functional execution. The portfolio version should pair this with selected proof points.

Problem ownership

Start with a customer friction point and turn it into a testable product thesis.

Commercial thinking

Connect the experience to adoption, conversion, contribution and operating costs.

Evidence-led delivery

Define a narrow test, agree success criteria and use results to earn further investment.

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Suggested portfolio enhancement: add 2 to 3 verified achievements from prior roles that demonstrate measurable execution.

The concept could be explored with different travel platforms.

These are potential strategic contexts, not confirmed partners or evidence of an active EIR programme.

MakeMyTrip

Broad India travel marketplace. Potential lens: journey innovation and incremental booking conversion.

EaseMyTrip

Mass-market booking platform. Potential lens: differentiated planning and cross-sell.

Agoda

Global accommodation-led platform. Potential lens: destination planning and lodging conversion, subject to feature scope.

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Each platform would require a tailored assessment of existing features, customer needs, technical fit and economics.

Validate the problem before committing to the build.

The next step is discovery and a bounded proof of concept, not a commitment to a full product vertical.

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DISCOVERY SPRINT

Validate the customer problem, assess feature overlap and test strategic fit with one host platform.

- Interview target customers
- Review current platform journeys
- Select a narrow use case
- Define baseline, metrics and guardrails

DECISION GATE

Is the problem material enough to test?

If evidence supports the opportunity, resource a focused pilot and measure incremental value.

Direct and adjacent players shape the opportunity space.

Directional desk research based on public product descriptions. Not a comprehensive feature-by-feature audit.

Market categories

- Creator-led advice and itinerary commerce: GetSetYo, Fleeps, Weno
- Custom itinerary building and booking: Pickyourtrail
- Travel discovery, reviews and destination guidance: Tripadvisor
- AI-assisted travel planning and creator community: Viaje
- Concierge-led trip planning: Scenset
- Potential host platforms: MakeMyTrip, EaseMyTrip, Agoda

Questions for validation

- Is the customer pain frequent and material?
- What features already exist in target platforms?
- What do competing experiences enable today?
- What is the integration effort?
- Are unit economics incremental after costs?
- What sponsorship and operating model is viable?

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Public sources: fleeps.co | weno.travel/for-creators | pickyourtrail.com/itineraries | tripadvisor.com | viaje.in | scenset.com | makemytrip.com/about-us.php | getsetyo.com

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